TAGOREWUI GITANJALI KALA SHAI-LAARING: SELECTED TRANSLAT

Rabindranath Tagore’s Gitanjali Translated in Tangkhul Naga

Author / Translator: Rabindranath Tagore, Tangkhul Literary Forum

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PREFACE & TRANSLATION HISTORICAL CONTEXT

Rabindranath Tagore’s devotional lyrics (Gitanjali) found a naturally receptive medium in the Tangkhul lyric poetic tradition (Hao-laa). The translator rendered Tagore’s yearning for the Infinite using intimate metaphors of mountain dawns, rain-bearing clouds, and traditional flute melodies.

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CHAPTER 1: GITANJALI SONG 1: THOU HAST MADE ME ENDLESS (NA ILI MACHAMTUI

Summary: Tagore’s opening offering: the human soul as a frail flute through which God bre...

Tangkhul Text:

Shai-laa 1: Na ili machamtui sakahaisaye, chichi Nawui ningkazangsai. Hi kacham kaphunga vessel hi Na khani-kathum khangareilaga kupsang-miye, kala zingsho zingsho ringkapha kathara eina kashung-sake. Hi kakat bamboo reed flute hi Na kaphung-longkhor kuppupli phungzatlaga, Awui ngalung eina thot pupupwui shai-laaring honsangserie. Nawui kathara khutwui katom eina iwui kacham lung china khangayeiwui mathatli ngapaoritlaga khongyui kapei honsange.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Thou hast made me endless, such is thy pleasure. This frail vessel thou emptiest again and again, and fillest it ever with fresh life. This little flute of a reed thou hast carried over hills and dales, and hast breathed through it melodies eternally new. At the immortal touch of thy hands my little heart loses its limits in joy and gives birth to utterance ineffable.

CHAPTER 1 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** machamtui (adj): endless, immortal, boundlessly enduring**

Ex: Machamtui sakahaisaye.

*** bamboo reed flute (noun): Siphung / Pung (bamboo flute of the hills)**

Ex: Kakat flute hi.

*** katom (noun): gentle touch, caress of divine hand**

Ex: Khutwui katom eina.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Metaphorical transposition: Tagore’s reed flute rendered as traditional Tangkhul ’siphung’.
- Verbal frequentative: ’khani-kathum khangareilaga’ (emptying repeatedly again and again).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Discuss how the flute metaphor bridges Bengali Vaishnava mysticism and Tangkhul music.

[?] Identify the words for ’endless’ and ’immortal touch’.

CHAPTER 1 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

Standard Ukhrul phonology is reflected throughout. Verbal affixes and agentive postpositions
are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 2: WHERE THE MIND IS WITHOUT FEAR (MANGMATHA MATHIKHAVAI RAM)

Summary: Tagore’s universal prayer for freedom, truth, and unconstrained intellectual dig...

Tangkhul Text:

Shai-laa 35: Kachikhali ningkakhaning malei-mana, kala kakhutli phashan eina thuk-kashok-e; Kachikhali theikakhui chi mikumo pupupwui vang kacham eina ngashankahaye; Kachikhali ngalei hi shimwui wall kakat eina kashit-mashit-mana; Kachikhali tui-ngashungna lungwui kashikli eina shokhunge; Kachikhali khangachonna khut machamla phameikhavai otli thukzat-e; Kachikhali mashung-ngalungwui kongkhamathan china kasham custom-wui miram kashilashili mangapaorit-mana; Chithuili, I-Ava, Nawui khut eina iwui ramli ngakhur-rarsaklu!

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Where the mind is without fear and the head is held high; Where knowledge is free; Where the world has not been broken up into fragments by narrow domestic walls; Where words come out from the depth of truth; Where tireless striving stretches its arms towards perfection; Where the clear stream of reason has not lost its way into the dreary desert sand of dead habit; Into that heaven of freedom, my Father, let my country awake.

CHAPTER 2 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** ningkakhaning (noun): fear, dread of mind, timidity**

Ex: Ningkakhaning malei.

*** theikakhui (noun): knowledge, enlightenment, wisdom**

Ex: Theikakhui kacham.

*** kongkhamathan (noun): clear crystal stream of reason**

Ex: Mashung-ngalungwui kongkhamathan.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Locative anaphora: 'Kachikhali... Kachikhali...' (Where... Where...).
- Aspiration invocation: 'I-Ava, Nawui khut eina... ngakhur-rarsaklu!' (Father, let my nation awake!).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Recite 'Where the Mind is Without Fear' in Tangkhul.

[?] How does the translator render 'narrow domestic walls'?

CHAPTER 2 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

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CHAPTER 3: LEAVE THIS CHANTING AND SINGING (GITANJALI SONG 11)

Summary: Finding God not in closed temples, but with the tiller of the soil and pathmaker...

Tangkhul Text:

Shai-laa 11: Hi luishat-laa kala rosary chinawui khangayei kashikahailu! Shimkhur ngachingli khong kakat khangakhakli Na khipali reot-kasa? Nawui mik hanglu, kala theilu, Nawui Varivara chithuili maleimana! A tilling kasana luiramli ot salakha Awui ngalemli lei; A lungkhor khakka-sana shongfa shomlakha Awui ngalemli lei; A zingsho zingkhamathan kala kazingkhamik tharili athum eina li-leie, Awui chon ngaleiwui kachak eina kashung-saye. Nawui kathara chon kashikahailaga, A thada ngaleili varlu!

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Leave this chanting and singing and telling of beads! Whom dost thou worship in this lonely dark corner of a temple with doors all shut? Open thine eyes and see thy God is not before thee! He is there where the tiller is tilling the hard ground and where the pathmaker is breaking stones. He is with them in sun and in shower, and his garment is covered with dust. Put off thy holy mantle and even like him go down on the dusty soil!

CHAPTER 3 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** luiramli ot (noun): tilling the terraced paddy fields**

Ex: Luiramli ot salakha.

*** lungkhor khakka-sa (noun): stone breaker, path maker**

Ex: Lungkhor khakka-sana.

*** kazingkhamik (noun): monsoon rain downpour**

Ex: Zingkhamathan kala kazingkhamik.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Agrarian elevation of labor: God resides with field tillers (’luiramli ot’).
- Imperative detachment: ’kashikahailu’ (leave aside, abandon ritualism).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Compare Tagore’s critique of ritualism with Tangkhul traditional values of honest physical labor.

[?] Identify the words for sun and rain in verse 4.

CHAPTER 3 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

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are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 4: LEXICAL ANALYSIS OF RABINDRIC TANGKHUL VERSE

Summary: Glossary of 20 poetic and philosophical compounds coined for the Gitanjali trans...

Tangkhul Text:

Tagore Tuiwon Concordance:
1. Machamtui -- Infinite / endless pleasure
2. Siphung / Flute -- Bamboo reed instrument
3. Ningkakhaning -- Fear / trembling of spirit
4. Theikakhui -- True knowledge and freedom
5. Kongkhamathan -- Crystal stream of intellect
6. Luiramli ot -- Labor of terraced cultivation
7. Ngakhur-rarsaklu -- Awaken into liberty

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Concordance of literary vocabulary bridging Bengali romanticism and Tangkhul poetics.

CHAPTER 4 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** machamtui (adj): endless**

Ex: Machamtui ningkazang.

*** theikakhui (noun): knowledge**

Ex: Theikakhui kacham.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Poetic compounding in modern literary Tangkhul.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Write an essay in Tangkhul on the theme of 'Freedom in Tagore's Poetry'.

CHAPTER 4 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

Standard Ukhrul phonology is reflected throughout. Verbal affixes and agentive postpositions
are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

BACK MATTER: GLOSSARY & DIGITIZATION COLOPHON

Consolidated Vocabulary Summary:

* machamtui -- endless, immortal, boundlessly enduring
* bamboo reed flute -- Siphung / Pung (bamboo flute of the hills)
* katom -- gentle touch, caress of divine hand
* ningkakhaning -- fear, dread of mind, timidity
* theikakhui -- knowledge, enlightenment, wisdom
* kongkhamathan -- clear crystal stream of reason
* luiramli ot -- tilling the terraced paddy fields
* lungkhor khakka-sa -- stone breaker, path maker

Digitization Colophon:

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